

to cleave flying fruit in two, ideally before they hit the ground. Oh, and keep a watch out for bombs; mistakenly slice one, and it's game over. The app is integrated with OpenFeint (so you can compete with your friends), and it's an ideal app for commuters or for those stuck in a slow-moving grocery store line.

Cut the Rope

Angry Birds dominated the App Store in 2010, but Cut the Rope – an equally addictive puzzle-like game – gave it a run for its money at the end of the year. Featuring Om Nom – a wee green creature with none of the rage of the Angry Birds but all of the aww! factor – Cut the Rope requires players to manoeuvre a piece of hard candy through a maze of obstacles and rope-cutting, and into the open mouth of an eager Om Nom.

Pictureka

It's either Where's Waldo? for the iPhone generation, or hell for anyone who has ever lost their keys in a messy room. Pictureka presents gamers with a screen cluttered with objects, and a list of things they must find (think five pieces of fruit, or six objects from space). Find them all before the clock runs out and get rewarded with... a new list. Trust us, it's more addictive than it sounds.

Wurdle

With Wurdle, users spot then trace words from a grid of letters, acrostic-style, to see how many words they can make in a two-, three- or five-minute period. Stuck? Shake the phone to scramble the tiles, then get back to word hunting. At game's end the app will helpfully shame you with a list of all the words you missed, and also let you compare scores with friends or with other players online.

GeoDefense Swarm

The principle is simple: Stop the creatures by blasting them with strategically-placed cannons before they reach your base. When it comes to the gameplay itself, things can quickly — but entertainingly — spiral out of control. (Before you know it, the casualty count will include your phone battery.) GeoDefense Swarm is easy enough for a child to play, but mastering it takes a nimble mind and even nimbler fingers.